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DRUGGIST'S LIFE NOT A HAPPY ONE

WAR IS NOT ONLY BUSINESS
FOE THAT MUST BE MET;
"ISMS" TAKE TOLLS

TRADE NOT AS IN OLD DAYS

Filling of Prescriptions now Least Important Part of Game, Says One
Who Knows the "Inside"

"There are drugstores in our large cities today that don't even pretend to maintain a prescription department," said a veteran druggist to the Courier the other day. "They hang out an apothecary's sign, and then they run a novelty store and get by with it. Take it from me, the drug business is a fine thing to keep out of these days."

The man had read the article that appeared in the Courier a couple of weeks ago regarding the boost the European war had given drug prices, and of the way in which American druggists were suffering from the slaughter-fest abroad. And he wanted to talk about his troubles.

"Believe me," he said, "the war isn't all that is driving the drugstore men crazy. There are a lot of other things. In the good old days it used to be that the apothecary made a good living from filling prescriptions that the local doctors wrote. Pretty soon the edge began to go from the prescription business, because the doctors expected the druggist to print and give him free little prescription blanks. The paper had to be good stock and the printing had to be fancy. Then the big patent medicine companies began their advertising campaigns, and people quit letting the doctor prescribe for them, and prescribed for themselves. If the druggist didn't carry every kind of patent medicine there was, he began to lose trade."

"And then the 'isms' began to hit their business. The doctors felt it first and the druggist was right behind the doctor to get the job. There were 'druggess healers,' and 'scientists' and 'osteopaths' and 'neuropaths' and 'naturopaths' and 'chiropractors' and a lot of others, and they all had no use for the druggist. Then the prohibition laws came along—and believe me, until we were prohibited from selling wine and other things we didn't realize how much profit there was in that side of our business. And now the federal government has come along and put an awful damper on the sale of morphine, strychnine and other narcotic drugs—and while all of this is as it should be, the poor druggist has another source of revenue taken away from him."

"When the druggists first began to feel the pinch they started in putting a line of novelties, candy and cigars. But did they make up their lost profits on that? You bet they didn't. The candy stores began to underbid the druggist, the cigar store on the corner got a fancy display case and an electric sign, and funny writers in the magazines began to knock drug store cigars. And as for novelties, why the drugstore has the fiercest kind of competition for the straight novelty stores—and as we can't begin to carry as large stocks as they do, and so can't buy as cheaply, we are hit again."

"Honestly, the druggist is the hardest hit man in the community these days. Other business men may be pinched by competition, but the druggist is squeezed flat. People expect a drugstore to be open all the time; they expect a free telephone, and when they do buy something it is usually a five-cent stick of gum and two postage stamps. And they kick if we don't have stamps. About the only thing a druggist makes an old-time profit on now is soda water and ice cream, and we have to put up about two thousand dollars to get a showy fountain before we get that business. No sir, the war isn't the only thing that is 'knocking' the druggist—it's a mighty poor business to start in right now."

"Just to show you that I mean this, and that it isn't moonshine, I want to tell you about a friend of mine who went to a large city and opened a drugstore. He was wise to the game, he was. He put in a soda fountain and a lunch counter, a line of soap and some stationery, and some candy, and a lot of toys and some novelties, and a couple of telephone booths, and a branch postoffice, two dozen boxes of live pills, and a gross of bottles of headache cure, and then he put up a big electric sign that said drugstore."

"The night he opened up an automobile ran into a lamp post in front of his place, and they brought the injured into the store. A doctor looked up from somewhere, and told the druggist to bring him some iodine, gauze and some peroxide quick—and wanting to oblige and make a hit, the druggist ran out the back door and chased three blocks to another drugstore and bought the stuff, paying retail prices for it out of his own pocket. And when he got back with it everybody was sore because it took him so long to get it, one woman got hyster-

CHAUTAUQUA HEAD QUILTS

Harvey Cross Resigns Post After Many Years Faithful Service

At a meeting of the directors of the Willamette Valley Chautauqua association, held this week, the Hon. Harvey E. Cross, for the past 23 years secretary of the organization, resigned his office and declined to again accept the responsible position which he has so long and successfully held. Mr. Cross will remain as a member of the executive committee of the Gladstone Chautauqua, and still retains ownership of the park where the annual meetings are held. No successor for the office of secretary has been selected.

Mr. Cross, by his wise management of the details of the annual Chautauqua has been largely responsible for the great success of the institution at Gladstone, and which has drawn hundreds of people annually to the superb camping and outing grounds where the meetings are held. Under his direction the assembly has grown and prospered until it has attracted the finest lyceum talent in the nation; and that it has done a great deal of good there is no doubt.

In giving up the detail management of the Chautauqua Mr. Cross leaves the organization with all of its debts paid and with a balance of some \$1,800 in the treasury. Part of this sum will probably be expended in repairing the large auditorium and in making improvements on the grounds before the next season opens.

C. H. Dye was elected president of the organization for the ensuing year at this week's meeting, and committees were named as follows: Executive, C. H. Dye, H. E. Cross, W. A. Huntley; finance, John W. Loder, J. E. Jack, George A. Harding; grounds and restaurant, George A. Howe, George C. Armstrong, Mrs. Jennie M. Kemp; athletics, Chris Schuebel, F. A. Olmsted and W. A. Huntley; transportation, E. G. Caulfield, Mrs. A. B. Manley, Mrs. Emma M. Spooner. The 1916 program was left with the executive committee with power to act.

IDAHO GOVERNOR HERE

Moses Alexander Visits County Seat and Great Woolen Mills

Moses Alexander, governor of Idaho, and "the only cultured democrat in the Northwest," was a visitor in Oregon City Tuesday of this week, the guest of General Manager Jacobs of the Oregon City woolen mills. While here Gov. Alexander looked at the elevator—but didn't ride in it—had dinner at Mass's restaurant, and inspected the woolen mills, which he declared to be "the finest woolen manufacturing plant in the Northwest."

The governor of Idaho made a very large purchase of woolen goods, including mackinaw clothing, shirts and blankets and a full assortment of lesser goods; all of which will be shipped to stores in which he is interested in Idaho.

"Good times are coming quickly," said the visiting governor. "Everywhere there are signs of increased business, and I expect to see 1916 one of the most successful years that the country has seen."

BIG CHANGE MADE

Oregon City Commercial Club now Welcomes Visitors to City

This week was an epoch-making time in Oregon City. This week saw one of the greatest changes in the county seat that ever occurred. This week saw the disappearance of snobishness in certain quarters, and the throwing wide of the portals of friendship to the stranger within our gates.

"THIS WEEK SAW THE WORD 'PRIVATE' TAKEN OFF THE DOORS OF THE COMMERCIAL CLUB."

This action was taken at a meeting of the Board of Governors of the club Wednesday afternoon.

The Courier, many months ago, suggested that the door of the Commercial club was about the poorest place in the world for the word "Private;" and urged the noble Oregon City boosters to at least appear to welcome visitors to the city. The Courier is glad to see that its criticism has resulted in a change; and hopes it will be the forerunner of other changes for the better.

Canby "Pioneer" Dies

Tuesday afternoon as the well known R. S. Coe happened into our office we noticed that he was not in the mood he usually is, and upon inquiring of Mr. Coe what the main difficulty was he informed us that his old faithful servant horse, Prince, had died the morning before. Prince had seen much hard service and had been in the Coe family for over eighteen years. R. S. stated that he passed away at the ripe old age of 32 years. (Canby Herald.)

"Printing with a punch"—at the Courier.

ical, and the newspapers fund out about it and next day roasted the place to a frazzle in the press—and two weeks later that druggist had a sign on the front of it that read "Closed by the Sheriff." Oh yes, the drug business is a fine business right now—and if you sell school books, talking machines, crockery, carpet sweepers, hot lunches and a side line of fresh eggs."

ULTIMATUM SENT POWER COMPANY

IF MAIN STREET PAVING IS NOT
REPAIRED, PORTLAND CARS
WILL BE HALTED

CITY FATHERS SHOW SPIRIT

Council Meeting is Dull Affair till
Closing Moments, when Sparks
Begin to fly Right Merrily

City Attorney Schuebel was instructed by the council Wednesday evening to notify President Griffith of the Portland Railway, Light & Power company, that unless his road took immediate action to repair the paving beside its tracks on Main

street, Oregon City, the police would halt all cars at Greenpoint and forbid the line use of the city's chief business thoroughfare.

This action came as a result of a two weeks' delay on the company in paying attention to complaints sent by City Engineer Miller, City Attorney Schuebel, and members of the street committee of the council regarding the condition of the Belgian block between the streetcar rails and the new hard surface paving of Main street. Twice the company has promised to send a crew of men to fix the matter up, and the crew has not yet appeared.

The trouble, according to City Engineer Miller, is that water which formerly seeped through the cracks of the old brick paving is now unable to find an outlet through the impervious Worswick pavement, and so seeps down between the Belgian blocks on the interurban line right-of-way, and sluices about beneath the ties, causing the track to sink and expose the edge of the hard surface pavement—which is being rapidly chipped off by street traffic. The railway tracks must be raised to grade again, it is said, and the blocks between them

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MUNITIONS RING PINCHES LABORER

IN SPITE OF TREMENDOUSLY
INCREASED PROFITS, LOW
WAGES ARE THE RULE

FEDERAL QUERY SHOWS FACT

Argument Advanced for Government
Ownership of Plants Which is
of Importance to Everyone

(By Clyde H. Tavenner)

Thanks to an investigation of the Bethlehem Steel Co.'s strike in 1910, information is available as to conditions of labor in that armor-making concern's plants. The inquiry was made by the United States Bureau of

Labor in 1910, under the direction of Ethelbert Stewart, a special agent of the Labor Bureau at the time, who bore the reputation of being one of the most experienced economic investigators in the country.

When this strike began there were no labor organizations in the plant; the company would not permit them. It was the higher grade workmen who led off in the strike. Many of the highest-grade men had approximately a 10½-hour day. But they were frequently being required to work overtime on week days and to do additional work on Sundays. Fearing that the encroachment of overtime and Sunday work were leading to a 12-hour and 7-day schedule for the whole force, they therefore protested. Therefore the protesting committee was discharged; therefore the strike.

The Government investigation revealed this:
Out of every 100 men—29 working 7 days every week; 43, including these 29, working some Sundays in the month; 51 working 12 hours a day; 25 working 12 hours a day, 7 days a week; 46 earning less than \$2 a day.

These are the grim figures which (Continued on Page 8)

ELEVATOR MAKES SUCCESSFUL TRIP

MUNICIPAL LIFT CARRIES ITS
FIRST LOAD OF HUMANITY

HIGH UP STEEL TOWER

NO CEREMONIES GREET ACT

Man Who Built First Steps on Face
of Bluff is among Passengers
To Make Initial Ride

Before 1874 anybody who wanted to get to the top of the bluff in Oregon City had to trudge up the Singer hill trail, or else could scramble over one of the Indian paths that led up the face of the rock wall that borders the river back of the business section of the city. Up at the top of the bluff was the end of the old Oregon Trail. In 1874 G. R. H. Miller built a winding flight of wooden steps, supported on tall joists, up the face of the cliff, and people hailed the stairway as a great improvement.

On November 15, 1915, 41 years after the first steps were built, the man who constructed the first "improvement" was lifted from the lower city level, at the head of Seventh street, to the top of the bluff without any exertion on his part. For on that day, which was last Monday Oregon City's free municipal elevator made its first trip, and G. R. H. Miller was one of the first passengers to make the ascent.

When Mr. Miller's first flight of steps was completed, the pioneers of that day thought a great feat had been accomplished, and they celebrated with a brass band and speeches. When Mr. Miller went up, with others, in the elevator, only a score of people knew anything about it; and there was no band and no speechmaking. But in the intervening years, Mr. Miller had seen great changes in Oregon City, and the few people remaining who climbed the first steps had seen a modern city grow about and beyond those old steps.

Oregon City's elevator has been long spoken of as the jinx of the county seat. Though it was authorized three years ago, litigation and grief delayed its operation until this week—and to further carry out the idea of the jinx, it is to be remarked that thirteen people made the first ascent in the car. Those who risked the "hoodoo" and who boarded the big iron cage for the first hoist up the steel tower, were: G. R. H. Miller, John F. Albright, chairman of the elevator committee of the council; W. A. Long, chairman of the water committee of the council; Linn E. Jones, mayor of the county seat; the Rev. W. L. Milliken, pastor of the First Baptist church; E. L. Shaw, chief of police; E. R. Brown, George Randall, I. Shockley, City Engineer Miller, William Andersen, chairman of the South Fork Water Commission, W. L. Mulvey and an operative of the Otis Elevator company.

The elevator went up to the top of the tower at half speed, and after a pause, came slowly down. No effort was made to make the trip in quick time, as the elevator had not been tested by the state labor commissioner's office. Labor Commissioner Hoff will get around to this detail as soon as office routine permits. The initial ascent of the elevator was made at 12:29 p. m., and no hitch occurred to mar the trip.

The elevator requires 250 gallons of water for each round trip. It will accommodate 15 persons at a time, and is designed to make 20 round trips an hour. No charge will be made for travel upon it during the remainder of the year, and it is not believed that the incoming council will attach any charge to it.

Persistence in testing out the "jinx" that has been hovering over the elevator resulted in a "skidoo party" making the trip Tuesday at noon, when 23 citizens made the ascent. Nothing happened, and Jack Albright, head of the elevator committee, says that if the lift can carry 13 people one day and 23 the next, it must be all right.

GLADSTONE MAY GROW

The Gladstone Commercial club has called a meeting of interested citizens for Friday evening, at which time plans for the enlargement of Gladstone will be taken up. The plan that will be laid before the meeting calls for the annexation of all territory north to Glen Echo, and west to the banks of the Willamette. It is also possible that the lively city will consider stretching its boundaries south along the river, till it meets those of Oregon City, and including in Gladstone the "China gardens."

The increased territory is desired to give Gladstone property with an assessed valuation of close to a million dollars, so that with a three-mill levy many improvements may be made. Good and modern roadways directly on the line of Portland travel, are among the betterments that will be proposed if the annexation scheme is approved by those property owners who will be affected.

OFFICIAL COUNTY BUDGET

For Clackamas County, Oregon, Containing Estimates of Public Expenditures for the Year 1916.

Notice is hereby given that on Tuesday, December 14, 1915 in the County Court room in the City of Oregon City, a meeting of the County Court will be held for the purpose of levying taxes to defray probable expenses of the County, and that at said time and place any taxpayer subject to such levy when made, may be heard in favor of or against any proposed tax levies as may be required to raise the amounts as shown by the itemized estimate of contemplated expenditures from the moneys proposed to be raised by taxation, as made by the County Court, being as follows:

Estimate of amount of money to be raised by taxation for the year 1916 for each department of county government, also the tax levied by all school districts, all road districts and all cities within Clackamas County, as provided by Chapter 234, Laws of 1913:

Roads and highways.....	\$210,000.00	
Bridges.....	30,000.00	
Total.....	\$240,000.00	
Registration and election.....	9,000.00	
Sheriff's Office—		
Sheriff's salary.....	1,700.00	
Sheriff's chief deputy.....	900.00	
Sheriff's special deputies.....	900.00	
Investigating crime, livery, etc.....	1,200.00	
Stamps and stationery.....	25.00	
Tax Department: Chief Deputy.....	400.00	
Second deputy.....	720.00	
3 Deputies 3 months in spring.....	540.00	
2 Deputies 2 months in fall.....	360.00	
Stamps, stationery and post cards.....	235.00	
Bond.....	210.00	
Total.....	7,630.00	
Clerk's Office—		
Clerk's salary.....	1,500.00	
Clerk's chief deputy.....	900.00	
Clerk's second deputy.....	840.00	
Clerk's third deputy.....	720.00	
Postage and box rent.....	130.00	
Two typewriters.....	125.00	
Office supplies and stationery.....	125.00	
Filing cases.....	50.00	
Bond.....	35.00	
Total.....	4,425.00	
Recorder's Office—		
Recorder's salary.....	1,200.00	
Deputy and book machine operator.....	300.00	
One book machine operator.....	840.00	
Extra help.....	130.00	
Stamps and box rent.....	100.00	
Bond.....	10.00	
Envelopes and stationery.....	35.00	
Ribbons for book machine.....	25.00	
Ink, pens, pencils, etc.....	10.00	
Repair on book machines.....	15.00	
New book machine.....	210.00	
Recovering records.....	30.00	
Total.....	4,285.00	
Treasurer's Office—		
Treasurer's salary.....	1,000.00	
Treasurer's deputy.....	720.00	
Listing and adding machine.....	396.00	
Fire proof counter and shelves.....	750.00	
Bond.....	175.00	
Stamps, ink and pencils.....	60.00	
Special receipt books.....	20.00	
Total.....	3,121.00	
Surveyor's Office—		
Cost of road surveys, viewmen, chainmen, markers, and mileage.....	3,000.00	
Office equipment and stationery.....	1,000.00	
Road index maps.....	1,500.00	
Typewriting.....	120.00	
Total.....	5,620.00	
Assessor's Office—		
Assessor's salary.....	1,250.00	
Assessor's chief deputy.....	900.00	
Assessor's second deputy.....	660.00	
Assessor's third deputy.....	600.00	
Assessor's field deputies.....	1,800.00	
Extending tax roll.....	400.00	
Stamps and traveling expenses.....	35.00	
Pens, ink and office supplies.....	15.00	
Total.....	5,720.00	
Court House—		
Two janitors.....	1,500.00	
Water.....	60.00	
Wood.....	200.00	
Coal.....	325.00	
Brushes.....	32.00	
Toilet paper.....	12.00	
Towels.....	15.00	
Mops.....	15.00	
Lawn hose, etc.....	20.00	
Oil.....	15.00	
Locks and repairs.....	15.00	
Glass.....	15.00	
Ice.....	10.00	
Plumbing.....	75.00	
Lamps.....	30.00	
Miscellaneous.....	25.00	
Total.....	3,364.00	
Circuit Court.....	11,000.00	
County Court—		
County Judge salary.....	1,200.00	
Clerk hire.....	120.00	
Postage and stationery.....	50.00	
One County Commissioner.....	900.00	

One County Commissioner.....	900.00	
Commissioners' traveling expenses.....	600.00	
Total.....	3,770.00	
Justice Court.....	3,000.00	
Coroner.....	1,000.00	
Insane.....	300.00	
School Superintendent's Office—		
School Superintendent's salary.....	1,000.00	
One school supervisor.....	1,100.00	
Clerk.....	480.00	
Expense of Superintendent.....	300.00	
Truant officer.....	100.00	
Postage and express.....	200.00	
Supplies.....	200.00	
Eighth grade examinations.....	108.00	
Institute.....	250.00	
Furniture.....	50.00	
Teachers' examination.....	25.00	
Total.....	3,813.00	
Health Officer—		
Health officer's salary.....	698.20	
Fumigating and disinfectants.....	1,000.00	
Traveling expenses.....	300.00	
Registrars.....	250.00	
Total.....	2,248.20	
Fruit Inspector, per diem and expense.....	500.00	
Stock Inspector.....	50.00	
Indigent Soldier.....	300.00	
Widow's Pensions.....	11,000.00	
Care of Poor—		
Cost of keeping.....	10,000.00	
Hospital bills.....	2,000.00	
Total.....	12,000.00	
Jail—		
Board of prisoners.....	1,000.00	
Jail fixtures and supplies.....	100.00	
Total.....	1,100.00	
Juvenile Court—		
Juvenile officer.....	500.00	
Juvenile matron.....	500.00	
Total.....	1,000.00	
Scalp Bounty.....	550.00	
Tax Rebate.....	450.00	
Printing and Advertising—		
Publishing County Court proceedings and expenditures.....	1,000.00	
Advertising for bids.....	200.00	
Assessor—Tax rolls, printing and advertising.....	550.00	
Clerk—Registers, journals and blanks.....	500.00	
Recorder—Blank records, deeds 54, mortgage 90, chattel mortgage 18.....	162.00	
Sheriff—Cash books 120, receipts 150, post cards 20.....	290.00	
Total.....	3,302.00	
State and County Fairs.....	400.00	
For Purchase of County Fair Grounds.....	7,350.00	
Sealer of Weights and Measures.....	425.00	
Rent of Armory.....	300.00	
Forest Fires.....	500.00	
Exporting County Books.....	350.00	
Damages.....	2,000.00	
Cattle Indemnity.....	1,600.00	
Insurance—		
Insurance on Court House.....	180.00	
Insurance on Bridges.....	400.00	
Total.....	580.00	
For State Tax, estimated.....	125,000.00	
For School Tax, estimated.....	96,000.00	
For School Library Fund.....	1,200.00	
District Attorney's Office—		
Expenses in enforcing dry law.....	3,000.00	
Total.....	3,000.00	
Schools.....	94,400.00	
Library.....	1,180.00	
Receipts Clerks' office.....	7,000.00	
Receipts Recorder's office.....	6,500.00	
Fines in Circuit Court.....	720.00	
Fines in Justice Court.....	1,400.00	
Total.....	26,756.49	
Balances on hand Nov. 1, 1915—		
Special School fund.....	11,813.89	
City fund.....	1,752.81	
General fund.....	9,541.34	
County School fund.....	1,450.78	
County Fair fund.....	35	
State School fund.....	353.37	
Institute fund.....	213.92	
1915 Taxes Collected.....	173.20	
Total.....	66,472.26	